

Van Gogh

Before taking up painting at 27, Vincent van Gogh (1853–90) worked as an art dealer, a teacher and an evangelist. He is now generally considered the greatest Dutch painter after Rembrandt and a huge influence on the development of modern art. Influenced at first by Rembrandt, Rubens and Gustave Doré (1832–83), then later by Millet, Japanese prints, the Impressionists and some of the Post-Impressionists, his art is linked to several movements, including Post-Impressionism, Expressionism and Symbolism. In ten years, he produced more than 2,000 artworks, including 864 paintings and 1,200 drawings and prints. Most of his best-known works were created in the final two years of his life.

Initially, he painted with a dark palette inspired by Rembrandt, but after living and working with Gauguin for two months in 1888–89, he developed an expressive, swirling style of thick impasto paint and brilliant colours that was both instinctive and personal. He often used paint squeezed straight from the tube onto his canvases, and distorted form and colour to express his feelings.



Van Gogh, *Vincent's Bedroom in Arles*, 1888